

The Governing Playbook

SCHEDULING — DRIFTING — GOVERNING

Your cadence is load-bearing. It forces decisions, surfaces drift early, and holds the seams whether or not this quarter's relationships are warm. The rhythm — not goodwill — is doing the work. That is rare, and it is the point of the architecture. Your task now is not to build it. It is to keep it from quietly decaying.

THE RISK

The governing rhythm is the first thing to go under pressure.

YOUR MOVES

- 01** **Protect the cadence first under load.** When things get busy, the governing meeting is the first thing cut “just this once.” Decide now that it is structurally un-cancellable — and hold that line hardest when you are most tempted to break it.
- 02** **Use the cadence as a fidelity check.** Do not just review status; test understanding. Have people explain priorities back in their own words. Catch drift in the rhythm, before it reaches the metrics.
- 03** **Extend the discipline as you scale.** Every new dependency is a new seam. Do not let the next one run on goodwill — bring it under the same governing rhythm before it slips.

THIS WEEK

Name the one rhythm you would protect last, and make it structurally impossible to cancel. That is the spine of your architecture.

Build the cadence. The seam will hold.
Lead the Way.